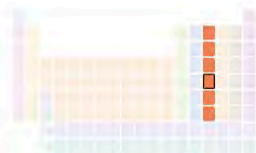
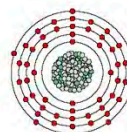


51
Sb

Antimony



State: Solid
Discovery: c. 1600 BCE

Forms



Jamesonite

These needle-like crystals contain antimony, lead, and iron.



Stibnite

This mineral tarnishes on contact with air.



This silvery semi-metal is hard but brittle.

Pure antimony crystals refined in a laboratory

Uses



These metallic letters are used by some printing presses, and are made of an antimony-tin alloy.

Printing press metal type



These matches with antimony in the tip burn brighter than the ones without it.

Safety matches



Egyptian kohl

Kohl is a dark eyeshadow.

Kohl makes it **easier to see** in strong sunlight.

Antimony gets its name from the Greek word *anti-monos*, meaning “not alone”. This may refer to the fact that the element is never found pure in nature, but is always found combined with heavier metals, such as lead. The element’s symbol, Sb, comes from *stibium*,

the Latin word for kohl, a form of eye make-up. The mineral ore **stibnite** is the largest source of **pure antimony**. Its pure form is mostly used to make hard alloys, such as that in the **metal type** used by some printers. Ancient **Egyptian kohl** was made from powdered stibnite.